RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

21 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 8:47 PM, Wednesday 21 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 326 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 64 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,371 minutes at 9:00 PM (no takeoff or landing since 6:00 PM); Dammam moving, no halt since 5:59 AM

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,371 minutes at 9:00 PM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No takeoffs or landings on the Riyadh boards since the 6:00 PM edition; 326 Wednesday Riyadh flights cancelled (52%).
- Coalition says a Houthi drone aimed at the Southern Region was intercepted at about 7:08 PM; no damage or casualties reported.
- Riyadh airport account again gave no reopening date at 8:36 PM; Macron left Riyadh after meeting the Crown Prince.
- Dammam airport moving with no halt since 5:59 AM; 7 takeoffs and 11 landings since 6:00 PM, latest flyadeal F3317 from Jeddah at 8:21 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14358 min).

326	0/0	8
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

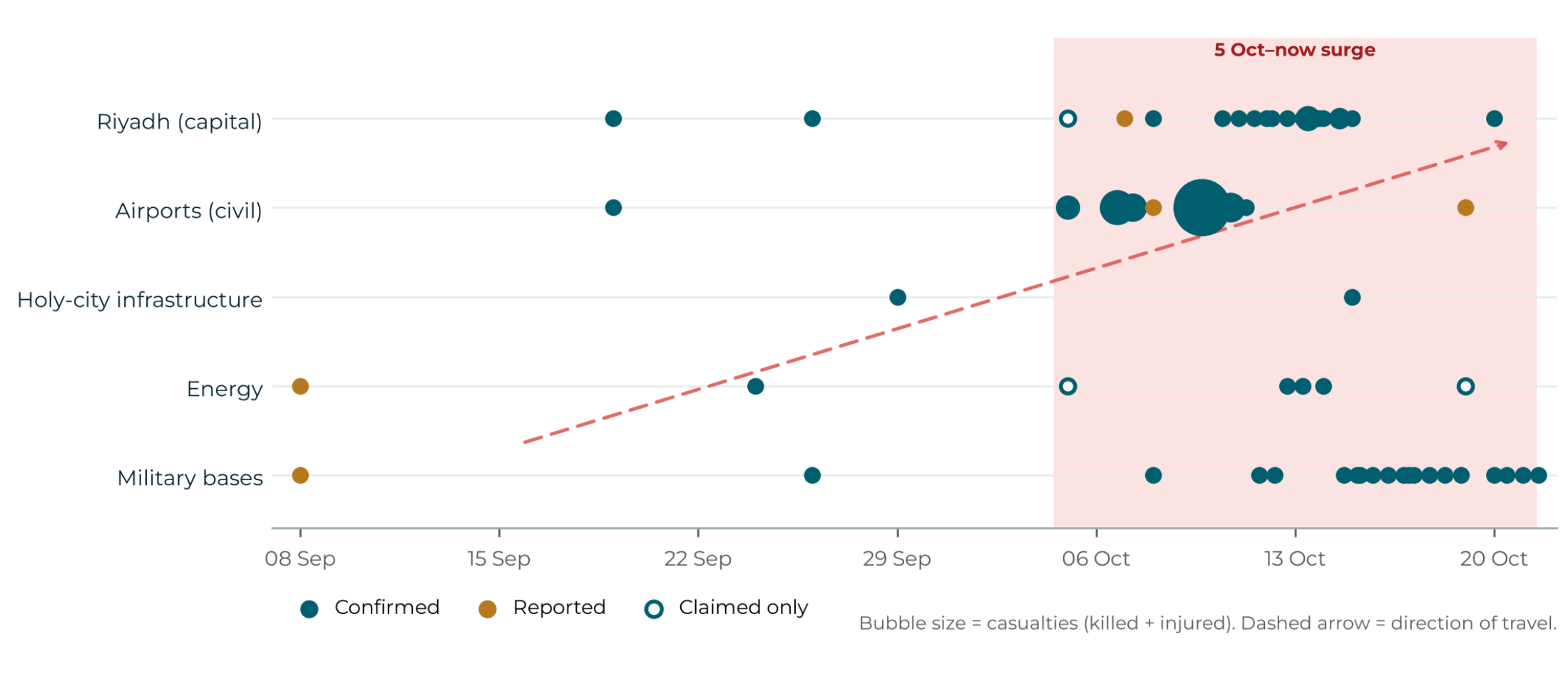
2 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

64	2/3	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,830 min at 12:00 PM); no takeoffs or landings since the 9:00 AM edition
- No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert reported in Saudi Arabia since 9:00 AM
- Yemen's central bank in Aden ordered assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships frozen (10:28 AM)
- Iran says Saudi Arabia has not answered its offer to mediate with the Houthis (Al Arabiya English, 10:01 AM; claim)
- Dammam moving with no halt; 9 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9:00 AM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 21 OCT



57 sourced events since 8 September (49 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: a Houthi drone launched toward the Southern Region intercepted and destroyed; no damage or casualties reported (21 Oct, Coalition spokesman via Al Arabiya English / Arab News; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 6:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **7:08 PM AST · Southern Region**

A Houthi drone launched toward the Southern Region intercepted and destroyed; no damage or casualties reported.
Coalition spokesman via Al Arabiya English / Arab News · none reported

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 3.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh still halted; new drone intercepted over the south; airport gives no reopening date; Dammam moving

Checked at 8:50 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Council of Senior Scholars: the Houthi militia is a terrorist group; attempts to target the Two Holy Mosques are terrorism**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:33 PM** · published 8:33 PM (SPA) and 8:39 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 8:50 PM

Saudi Arabia's top religious body said the Houthis' targeting of civilians in Yemen and their 'sinful attempt to target the Two Holy Mosques' is terrorism by every measure. It follows the coalition's report earlier today of drones intercepted over the Madinah region.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport again gives no reopening date, refers travellers to the authorities and their airline**

King Khalid International Airport (@KKIASA) · **8:36 PM** · replies posted 7:08 PM and 8:36 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 8:50 PM

Replying to travellers, the official Riyadh airport account again said that for airspace updates they should follow the official competent authorities or the airline they booked with. No date for scheduled flights to resume was given.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: Houthi drone launched toward the Southern Region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Malki, via Al Arabiya English / Arab News · **7:08 PM** · Al Arabiya English 7:08 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; Arab News 7:40 PM; checked 8:50 PM

The coalition spokesman said a drone launched by the Houthis toward Saudi Arabia's Southern Region was intercepted and destroyed. No damage or casualties were reported. Al Arabiya added at 7:23 PM that the coalition has intercepted five drones on Wednesday, including over the Madinah region.

CONFIRMED **French President Macron leaves Riyadh after meeting the Crown Prince**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:12 PM** · published 7:12 PM (SPA) and 7:15 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); SPA English 7:09 PM on the talks; checked 8:50 PM

SPA said the French President left Riyadh, seen off by the Deputy Emir of the Riyadh Region, after he and the Crown Prince discussed strategic ties and regional developments. His state flight is not on the airline boards.

CONFIRMED **Saudi state TV: Houthis target Aden and Al-Rayyan airports in Yemen**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:37 PM** · published 7:37 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV correspondent in Yemen, translated from Arabic); checked 8:50 PM

Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent says the Houthis targeted Aden and Al-Rayyan (Mukalla) airports in Yemen amid wide condemnation, and Hadramawt's local authority asked the international community to protect civilian sites. These airports are in Yemen, not Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman receives French President Emmanuel Macron in Riyadh**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) / SPA · **5:23 PM** · published 5:23 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); SPA English 5:27 PM; checked 5:56 PM

Saudi state TV and SPA reported the Crown Prince receiving President Macron in Riyadh on Wednesday evening. Saudi Gazette reported at 5:29 PM that Macron pledged French military support against Houthi attacks; no French or Saudi text of that pledge was found yet.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense urges caution as thunderstorms continue across most regions until Monday**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) / SPA · **5:34 PM** · published 4:55 PM (SPA) and 5:34 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 5:56 PM

Civil Defense says thunderstorms will continue over most of the Kingdom until next Monday and asks people to take care. Earlier, at 3:46 to 3:47 PM, it issued weather warnings for parts of the Makkah, Asir and Al Baha regions. This is a weather notice, not an attack warning.

CONFIRMED **Saudi state TV: Houthis block trucks with medicine, food and fuel from entering Taiz**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:03 PM** · published 5:03 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV correspondent in Yemen, translated from Arabic); checked 5:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent says the Houthis are stopping trucks carrying medical supplies, food and fuel from entering Taiz, and that more than 1.5 million residents are suffering under the siege, with hospitals appealing for help.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport account gives no reopening date, tells travellers to follow the authorities and their airline**

King Khalid International Airport (@KKIASA) · **4:58 PM** · reply posted 4:58 PM AST Wed 21 Oct to a traveller asking about the airport reopening; checked 5:56 PM

Asked for an update on the airport reopening, the official Riyadh airport account replied that travellers should follow the official competent authorities for airspace updates and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no date for scheduled flights to resume.

CONFIRMED **French President Macron lands at King Khalid International Airport, Riyadh**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Arabiya English · **4:23 PM** · SPA published 4:23 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; Al Arabiya English 4:33 PM named King Khalid International Airport; checked 5:56 PM

SPA and Al Ekhbariya said President Macron arrived in Riyadh and was met by the Deputy Governor of the Riyadh region; Al Arabiya English said the reception was at King Khalid International Airport. The state flight does not appear on the Flightradar24 airline boards, which still show no airline takeoff or landing at Riyadh since 3:02 AM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi and Jordanian foreign ministers sign amended coordination council protocol and review regional developments**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya · **4:11 PM** · SPA published 4:11 PM AST, Al Ekhbariya 4:28 PM Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 5:56 PM

Prince Faisal bin Farhan received Jordan's foreign minister in Riyadh and they signed an amended protocol for the Saudi-Jordanian Supreme Coordination Council chaired by the Crown Prince and the King of Jordan. Al Ekhbariya says they discussed regional events, led by the Houthis' continued strikes on Saudi territory.

UNVERIFIED **AP: Riyadh airport open to limited domestic traffic, with Saudia and flynas flying on Wednesday**

AP · **3:22 PM** · published 3:22 PM AST Wed 21 Oct, citing FlightAware; checked 5:56 PM

AP reports a limited number of Saudi airline flights took off and landed at Riyadh on Wednesday, two days after airlines were told they could resume with prior GACA permission (NOTAM A3650/26). The Flightradar24 boards we check show only the delayed Saudia SV982 departure at 3:02 AM and non-airline HZA8 today, so we cannot confirm a resumption.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14358 min).

326	4:33 AM	1:59 PM	0	8
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
156 departures + 170 arrivals, 52% of 631 scheduled.	HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 974 min before 8:47 PM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM.	HZA8 from Heraklion, 408 min before 8:47 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam, Qassim.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:47 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 306 at 8:48 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	156	170	326	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	147 (46%)	159 (51%)	306	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	3 (1%)	4 (1%)	7	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (57%)	2 (33%)	6	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	3 of 281	1 of 255	4 of 536	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	8	8	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	42	44	86	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	175	180	355	FR24 stats panel

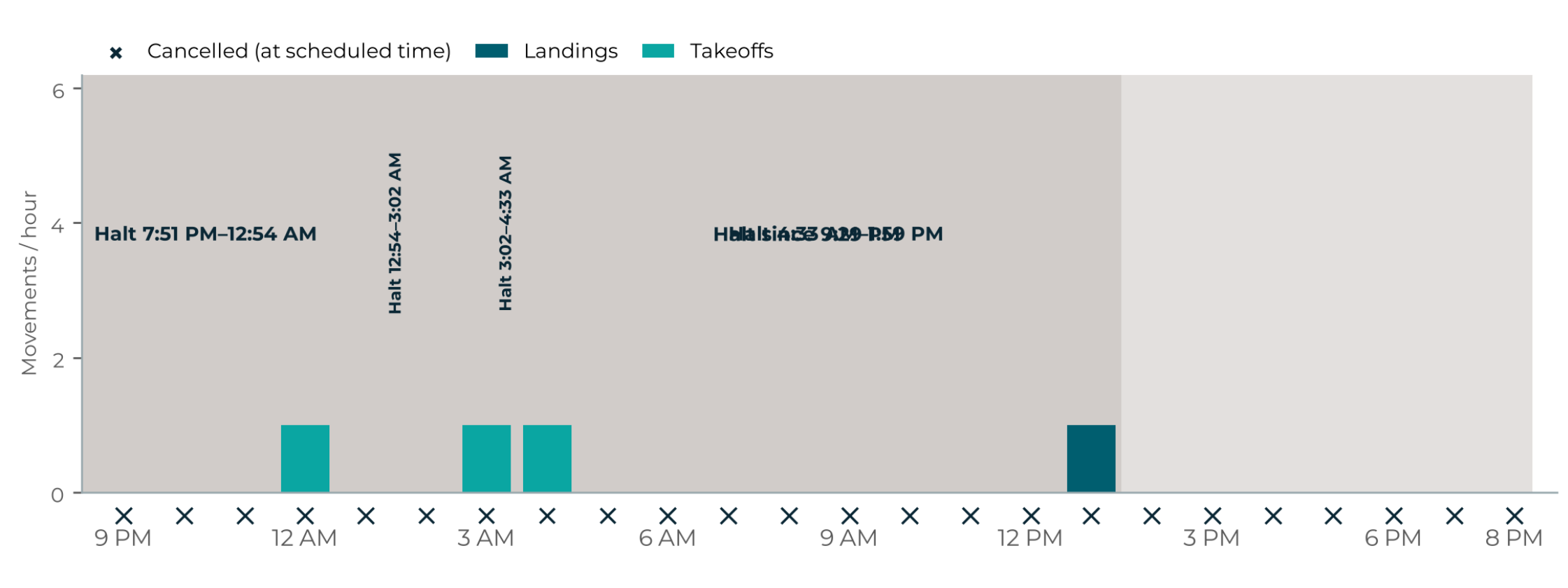
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	214
flynas	38
flyadeal	16
Gulf Air	10
Emirates	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	56
Madinah	29
Dammam	25
Dubai	24
Abha	17

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



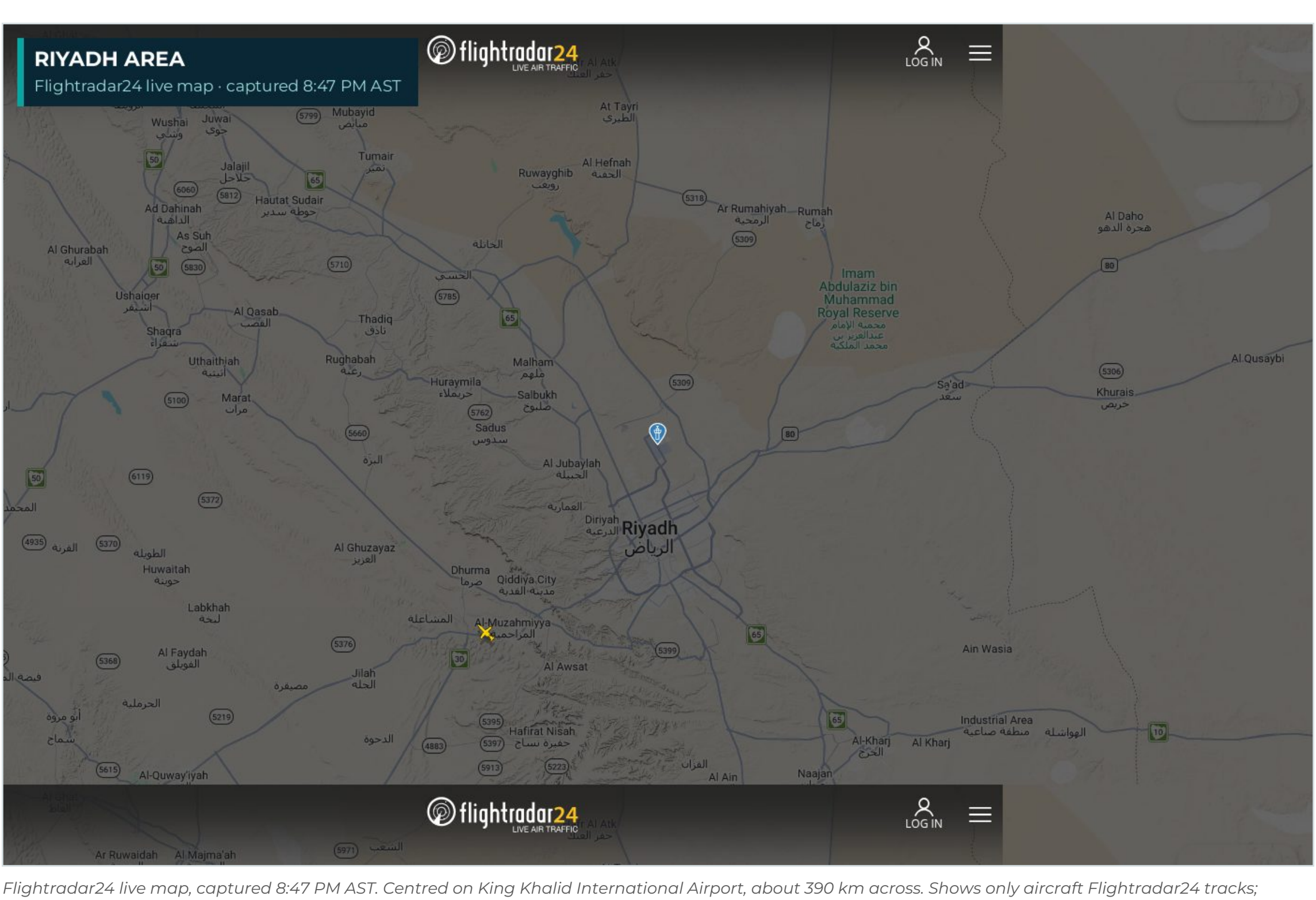
Recorded takeoffs (3) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 9:00 PM Tuesday to 8:47 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are delayed or non-scheduled flights: takeoffs HZSK5 to Geneva 11:05 AM and 0S2828 to Milan 5:36 PM Tuesday, Saudia SV992 12:54 AM, Saudia SV982 3:02 AM and HZA8 4:33 AM Wednesday, and the landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 7:43–8:37 PM Tuesday, 1:45–2:55 AM, and 3:58–6:01 AM Wednesday (ended when Air Arabia G9161 took off).

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 4:33 AM–1:59 PM	566 min
Halt 3:02–4:33 AM	91 min
Halt 12:54–3:02 AM	128 min
Halt 7:51 PM–12:54 AM	303 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	14358 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:47 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 2 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

64	8:11 PM	8:21 PM	2	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
31 departures + 33 arrivals, 28% of 229 scheduled.	F3467 to Madinah, 36 min before 8:47 PM.	F3317 from Jeddah, 26 min before 8:47 PM.	3 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:47 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 62 at 8:48 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	31	33	64	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	30 (25%)	32 (28%)	62	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	11 (9%)	9 (8%)	20	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	39 (78%)	39 (81%)	78	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	7 min	5 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	51 of 93	47 of 95	98 of 188	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	14	14	28	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	32	32	64	FR24 stats panel

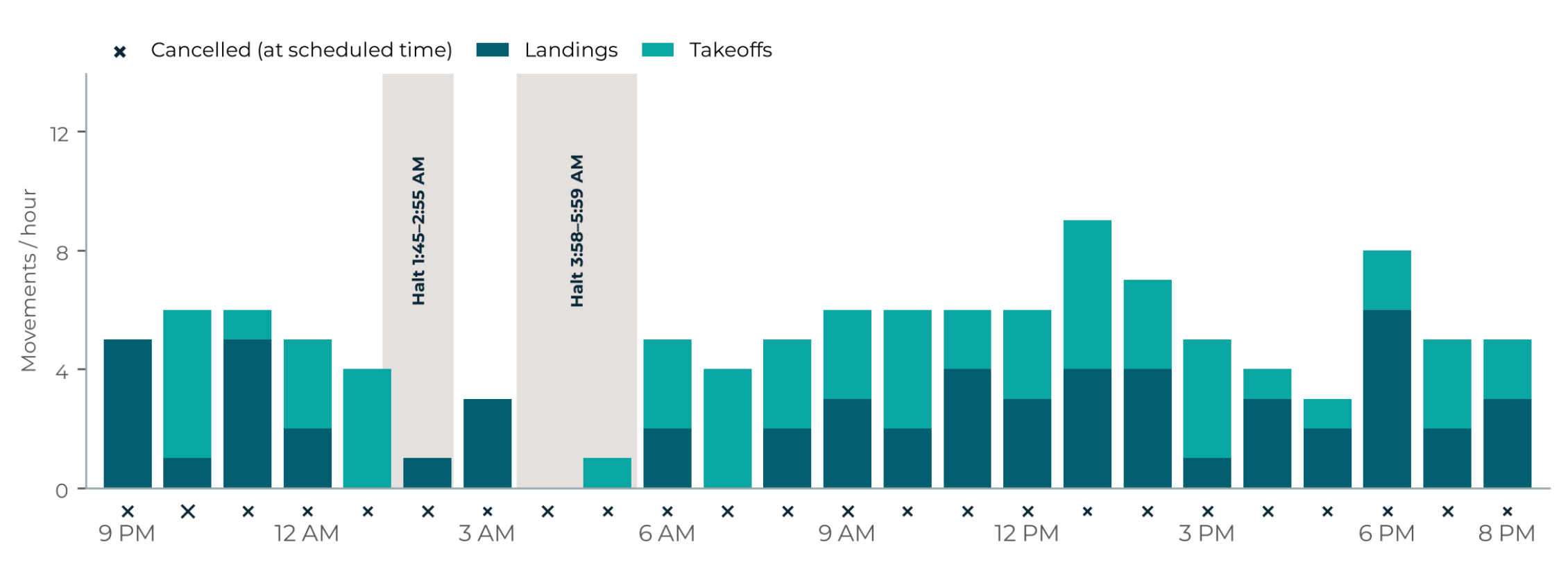
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	22
Egyptair	8
Etihad Airways	8
flydubai	8
Emirates	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	24
Dubai	14
Abu Dhabi	8
Cairo	6
Madinah	3

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (57) and landings (58) at DMM per hour from 9:00 PM Tuesday to 8:47 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 7 takeoffs and 11 landings since 6:00 PM, 2 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour; no halt since 5:59 AM.

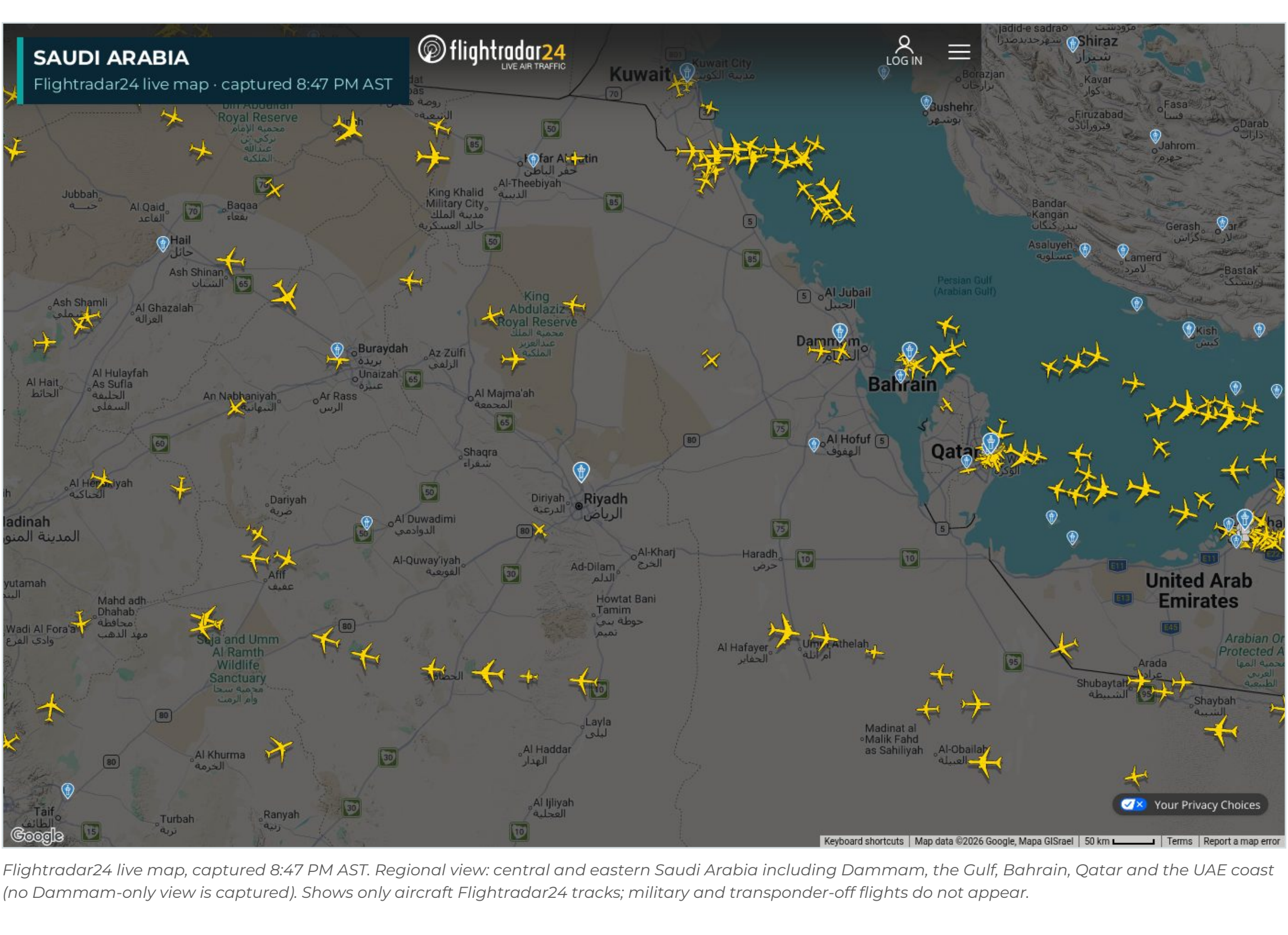
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 3:58–5:59 AM	120 min
Halt 1:45–2:55 AM	70 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (8:50 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:47 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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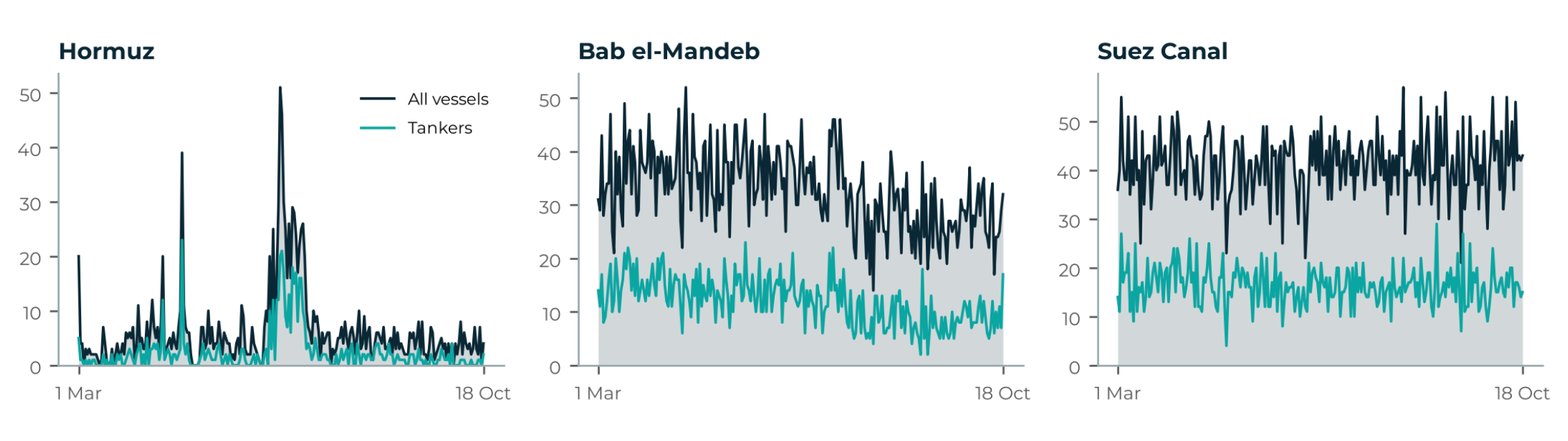
ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

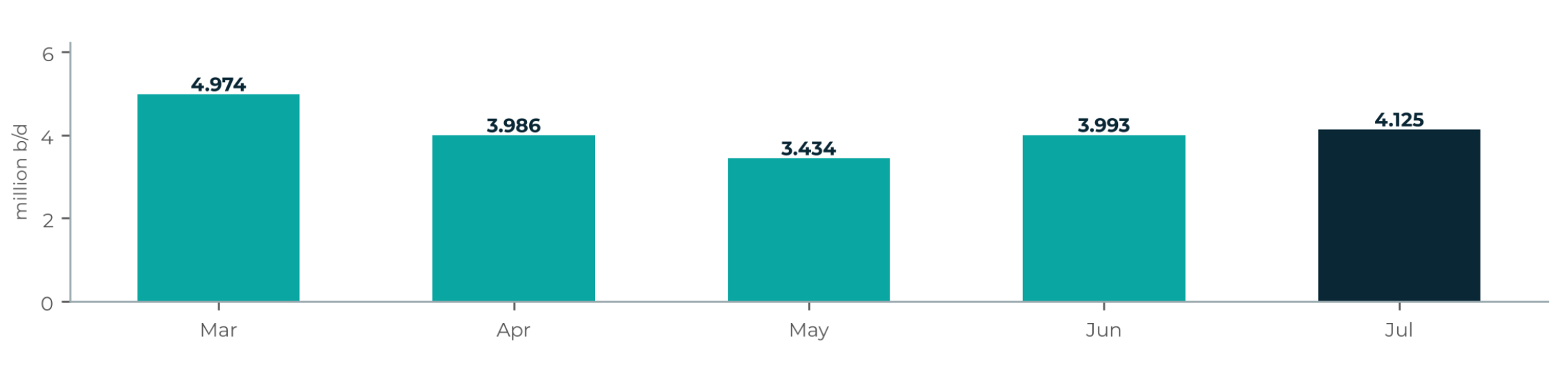
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 8:48 PM, Wed 21 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

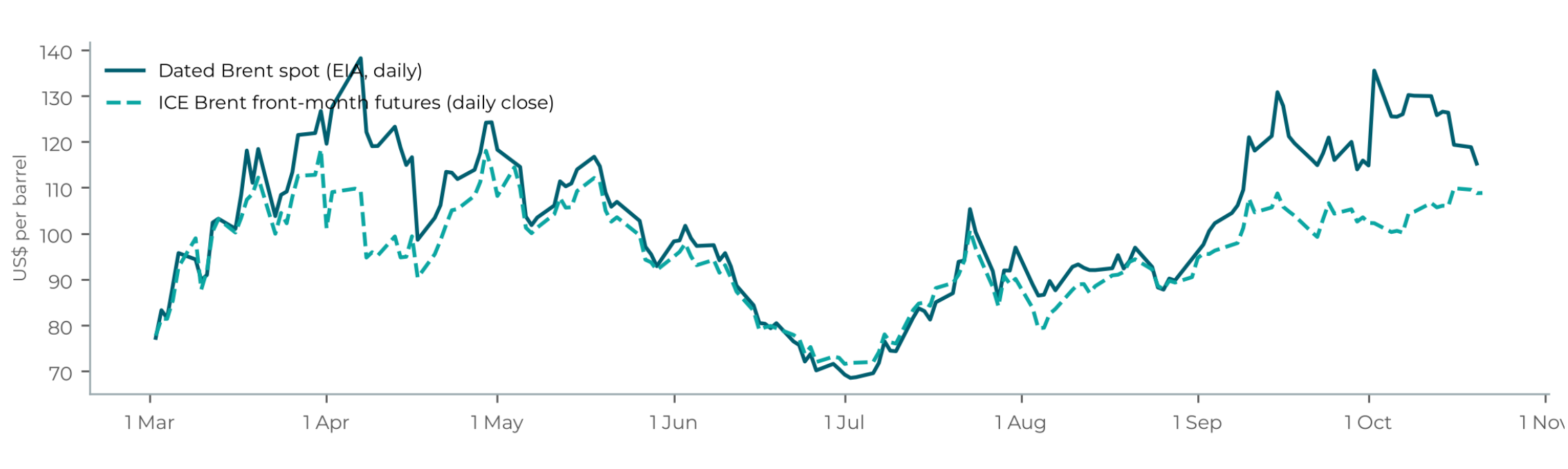


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$108.83	$115.22	-4%	+49%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 8:38 PM, Wed 21 Oct AST (+0.0% on day). Near real time.	Tue 20 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $119.66 on Fri 18 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 8:47 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]

[illegible]